

US 114051 · NQF LEVEL 5 · 4 CREDITS

Conduct a Technical Practitioners Meeting



Meeting types, leadership styles and decision-making — then prepare, chair and follow up a technical meeting of your own

TIME	SESSIONS	MODULE	QUALITY ASSURANCE
90-minute lessons · Self & Group	Fridays, 4 & 11 Sep 2026 · 09h00 – 14h00	Module 1 · Personal Development	QCOP / MITC / SETA

What you must be able to do

Four specific outcomes take you from knowing how meetings work to running one end-to-end. You will be assessed against these:



1 · Know the meetings

Describe the types of technical meetings and their uses; identify leadership styles, decision-making processes and meeting conventions.



2 · Prepare

Venue, facilities, technology and supporting information in place; clear documented outcomes; timeous invitations; agenda distributed.



3 · Chair

Establish rules with members, apply agreed conventions, follow the agenda, enable participation, prioritise topics, land clear decisions.



4 · Follow up

Accurate minutes per organisational policy; decisions communicated in the required format and timeframe; actions summarised.

Why technical practitioners meet

- Meetings are very important for the work of any organisation — they are where the technical team decides, plans and holds itself accountable.
- Good meetings support collective decision-making, planning and follow-up, accountability and democracy.
- The principal activities of a technical committee are the development and maintenance of its standards, technical reports and data files.
- A badly run meeting wastes the scarcest resource a technical team has — its practitioners' time.



By the end of this unit you will have prepared, chaired and minuted a technical practitioners meeting yourself — that is the evidence in your logbook.

Three meetings you must know

Organisations hold many kinds of meetings — general members, special, executive, AGMs. For technical practitioners, three types matter most:



Contract meetings

Discuss, review and manage contractual obligations and deliverables related to technical projects or services.



Technical review meetings

Evaluate technical solutions, designs and implementations, and resolve technical issues and problems.



Project review meetings

Assess project progress, timelines, resource allocation and project deliverables.

Who decides — the chair, the group, or both?

Three main leadership styles are used in meeting procedures. Choose the style that fits the meeting's purpose:



Democratic

The members decide through discussion and voting. The chair guides the process, but the group makes the decision.



Autocratic

The chairperson controls the meeting and takes the decisions; members give input only when asked. Fast — use with care.



Facilitative

A group effort: the facilitator guides the process while staying neutral, and the group produces the outcome together.

Five ways meetings reach a decision

Voting

Each member votes; the option with the majority is adopted.

Consensus

Discussion continues until every member can accept the decision.

Criteria-based rating

Score options against agreed criteria — the highest score wins.

Ranking

Members order the options by preference; rankings are combined.

Paired comparisons

Compare options two at a time; the overall winner is selected.

Match the process

Pick the process that fits the decision's importance, urgency and need for buy-in.

Order, fairness and effective decisions



Moving

Formally propose a motion for the meeting to consider.



Seconding

A second member supports the motion — unseconded motions fall away.



Amending

Modify the motion before the vote; amendments are voted on first.



Voting procedures

Show of hands, ballot or poll — counted and recorded by the chair.



The note taker needs a technical background — minutes must capture the terminology, decisions and reasons accurately.

Physical arrangements — nothing left to chance

Preparation is where a meeting is won. Four arrangements must be in place before anyone walks in:

Venue

Booked, accessible and set up for the meeting style — seating that lets practitioners face each other.

Facilities

Whiteboards, flip charts, stationery, refreshments — everything the discussion will need.

Technology

Projector, video conferencing, network access — prepared and tested before the meeting starts.

Supporting information

Reports, designs and data the discussion depends on — available to every participant.

Outcomes, invitations and the agenda



Document the outcomes

Intended outcomes must be clear, concise and well documented — the agenda is built around them and success is measured against them.



Invite timeously

Early invitations let participants prepare, study the documentation and arrange their schedules — so the right people attend.



Complete & distribute the agenda

The agenda and supporting documentation are completed and distributed to all participants before the meeting.

An agenda states the meeting's purpose, lists the items in priority order, and shows the time allocated to each.

Open with rules the members own

ESTABLISH RULES & GUIDELINES

- Agree the rules in conjunction with the members at the start
- How to get the floor, how long contributions may run
- How decisions will be taken — and what is in scope
- Agreed rules create buy-in and prevent procedural disputes

APPLY THE AGREED CONVENTIONS

- Run motions through moving, seconding and amending
- Follow the published agenda item by item
- Park unrelated issues and keep an eye on the clock
- Apply the conventions consistently — the same rules for everyone

Participation, priorities and decisions

- Provide for active participation by ALL members — invite quiet members by name, use round-robin turns, acknowledge every contribution.
- Keep debate on the issue, not the person — that is how conflict is minimised.
- Prioritise topics and allocate discussion time according to importance, urgency and complexity.
- Move minor items to the end of the agenda — or carry them over to the next meeting.
- Ensure agreed decisions are clear, accurate and include a time frame for action.
- Confirm each decision — and who owns it — with the members before moving on.

Managing difficult behaviours

Behaviour	What the chair does
The heckler	Stay calm; acknowledge any valid point and return to the agenda and agreed rules.
The overly talkative	Thank them, summarise their point, and invite someone who has not yet spoken.
The cynic	Ask for evidence and an alternative — turn the criticism into an agenda item or action.
The silent member	Invite their input by name on a topic they know well.
Conflicting egos	Keep debate on the issue, not the person; restate the meeting's outcomes.
Side conversations	Pause the meeting and draw the conversation back to the floor.
Factually wrong statements	Correct tactfully with the facts — or park the point for verification and record it.

The meeting is not over when it ends



Accurate minutes

Attendance, discussions, decisions and actions — produced in line with organisational policy and checked before distribution.



Communicate decisions

To all affected stakeholders, in the required format — minutes, e-mail or report — and within the required timeframe.



Summarise actions

Each action with its owner and deadline; unresolved items carried over to the next agenda.

Decisions that are not communicated and tracked might as well not have been taken.

Your work for this unit standard



Questioning sessions

Four AI-marked questioning exercises — meeting types, preparation, chairing and follow-up.



Knowledge check quizzes

Four quizzes across the unit. 80%+ is competent.



Chair a meeting

Role-play practical on Day 2 — every learner chairs a 10-minute technical meeting from a scenario card.



Logbook project — Meeting portfolio

Notice and agenda, invitations, attendance register, minutes and action summary. Mark it 114051.



Run the meeting — don't let the meeting run you.

Meeting types » leadership styles » decision processes » conventions » preparation » chairing » follow-up — the meeting skills every technical practitioner needs to turn discussion into action.